



Pickleball League Rules & Regulations

The USA Pickleball Official Rulebook will be used to guide league play. The PVTC league is a non-sanctioned event and the non-officiated play rules will be practiced. The league has the option to modify rules to better align with the program – those modifications are outlined in the Rules & Regulations listed below.

Team Rosters

1. Players must be at least 18 years of age. A copy of a valid photo ID and a signed waiver form (if you don't have one on file) is required for all players on your roster.
2. A maximum of **15 rostered players** is allowed per team for the season.
3. Teams must have approval from the league coordinator to add or delete players to the roster after the first league game of Week 1.
4. The league fee is due at time of registration to confirm your team's spot. Register with the PVTC front desk at (310) 373-6326
5. A player may only captain one team, in one skill level per league type in a season.
6. The final and full rosters are due one week prior to the first game.
 - a. Unless otherwise specified by the league coordinator

Division Movement/Placement

1. Team placement and movement will be determined by the team's average DUPR rating.
2. Any player or team observed to be playing in the wrong skill level division will be notified and moved to a higher skill level division if they choose to continue playing in PVTC leagues.
3. Teams do not automatically qualify for division movement based on season outcomes.
4. Players may only play in one skill level per league type.
5. Division Skill Range Averages:
 - a. 3.0: DUPR 2.75 to 3.25
 - b. 3.5: DUPR 3.25 to 3.75
 - c. 4.0: DUPR 3.75 to 4.25

Captains

1. Captains are responsible for sharing the league rules and making sure each of their players follow them.
2. Captains will be the primary point of contact for all communications throughout the season.
3. The team captain is responsible for collecting and turning in waivers and IDs for players who are new to the PVTC league in a team packet. Electronic submission is encouraged.
4. Captains **must arrive** with a hardcopy of their lineup in the format emailed to you.
5. Captains are responsible for checking in at the front desk to check availability of warm up courts.
 - a. **PVTC does not guarantee warm up courts.** Member reservations have priority and must be allowed to finish until their playing time ends. Please do not linger on the courts during their reserved time.
 - b. Teams may enter the courts 30 minutes prior to league. You may have to share the open courts with other teams.
6. The home team captain checks-in at the front desk and picks up the balls and clipboards.
7. Team captains must exchange lineups **10 minutes** prior to the league start time.

Match Format

1. Teams will play 2 rounds of 6 games. (12 games total)
2. Points are given separately for Round 1 and Round 2.
 - a. Teams will get 2 points for a win, 1 for a tie, and 0 for a loss.
3. Mixed doubles play format is 1 WD game, 1 MD game and 4 MXD games per round.
4. Games are played to 11 points, win by 1.
5. Both teams will switch sides when one team hits 6 points.
6. Both Captains will record scores on their copy of the lineup after each game
 - a. The home team's copy is used as the official record of the match.
7. Once all games are completed,
 - a. Captains should validate the final results,
 - b. Tally their games and points won each round,
 - c. Sign the home team copy.

Lineups

1. Only rostered players are allowed to compete in gameplay.
 - a. If a **non-rostered player** is used in a game, that game will be considered a **forfeit** and will not count towards a win.
2. **There will be a 15-minute grace period for the first game only.**
 - a. Players are allowed to arrive late or leave early for the match, but they must be present when the game they are scheduled to play begins. There is no grace period for subsequent games.
3. Players in all leagues **must rotate partners each game** and only play with the same partner once each round.

- a. The maximum number of games played per person, per round is 3.
 - b. If a player is injured and unable to continue, teams must still rotate partners and not duplicate partnerships in a round.
4. Each team must have a minimum of 4 players for each weekly match. A max of 8 people may play on any given day due to limited space and parking.

Timeouts & Injury Substitutions

1. Water breaks are allowed when teams switch sides at 6.
 - a. Teams have 1-minute max while switching sides
2. There will be NO official time outs except medical related.
 - a. If a player is injured or must urgently use the restroom they are allowed a **Medical Timeout**. (15 Minutes)
 - i. If that player is unable to continue, a **player not currently in the game** can be **substituted** in.
 - ii. It is the decision of the injured player's team to decide which player will play.
 - iii. If the injured player decides they can continue after being subbed out, they **must wait until the conclusion of round one** to be eligible to play in round two.
 - iv. If the injured player cannot continue, that **team may not shuffle their lineup**.
 - v. Eligible substitutes for the injured player must come from players who are not in the lineup at the time of the current game.
 - vi. If a team does not have subs and the injured player cannot continue, any game that the injured player was scheduled to play will be **forfeited**.

Line Calls

1. The games will be self-regulated -- call balls in/out of bounds fairly.
2. Any players sitting on the court/sideline and not playing may NOT talk, make calls, coach during play, or make any gestures to their teammates that insinuate something towards coaching.
3. Each team calls their own balls in/out on their side of the court only.
4. On the serve, if the ball bounces on any of the lines, it is "in", the only exception being the non-volley zone (kitchen) line, which is "out".
5. If a ball is questionable, it should be called "in".
 - a. If one player calls the ball out and their partner calls it in, doubt exists and the call is IN.
6. A player may appeal a call to the opponent's partner and respectfully accept the decision

Kitchen Violations, Foot Faults, and Incorrect Returner/Receiver Rules

1. Servers toe touches the line during the serve – **DO NOT CALL**
2. If a player makes an obvious/flagrant foot fault– **DO CALL**
3. If this is a consistent issue with a player, advise the league coordinator who will observe/advise **AFTER** the games are completed.

4. Players toe touches the kitchen line – **DO NOT CALL**
5. If a player makes an obvious/flagrant Kitchen Fault– **DO CALL**
 - a. Any player participating on the court can call a Kitchen Fault.
 - b. If the “offender”/team does not agree with the call the point will be replayed.
6. **KEEP FOOT FAULT CALLS AT A MINIMUM AS THIS DELAYS GAMES**
 - a. If there is a repetitive issue contact the league coordinator
7. If the correct server or receiver is NOT in the correct position when the score is called, players may stop before the receivers return the serve.
 - a. If the rally is played out the results of the point will stand and players will return to the correct positions.

This is a non-sanctioned league and is non-officiated play. We have a 2-hour limit to complete play per division and do not want to consistently delay the games due to numerous replay's which aren't necessary. If ongoing issues are occurring during games, text/email the league coordinator.

Scoring

1. The player serving must call out the score loud and clear for the returners to hear before hitting the serve.
2. If an incorrect score is called while serving, play can be stopped for correction **BEFORE** the return of serve is hit. The serve will be replayed.
 - a. If play is stopped **AFTER** the return of serve is hit, then it is considered a fault.

Equipment & Clothing

1. All players must provide their own paddles.
2. Game balls will be provided, however warmup balls are not.
3. Clothing – players are to avoid wearing clothing that closely matches the color of the ball
4. Eye protection is highly encouraged, whether you are playing during the day or night.

Cancellation of Matches and Rescheduling

1. Cancellation of the Entire Match is when no first serve of any match has been played.
 - a. An entire match may be canceled by mutual consent of the Captains or their representatives due to rain, strong winds, excessive heat, unhealthy air quality, poor court conditions, and more.
 - i. PVTC tries its best to allow league play to happen. Contact the PVTC Front Desk, at least 2 hours before the league start time to check on the current status of the courts.
2. Cancellations due to inclement weather must not be finalized until the morning of the match.
 - a. If the Captains or their representatives cannot reach each other by telephone or email on the morning of the match and/or if the weather is clearing, it should be assumed the match is to be played.

3. Start time may be delayed up to 30 minutes if courts will be playable.
 - a. If agreeable to both teams and courts are available, play may begin beyond the 30 minute delay.
 - b. Players who choose to leave the site run the risk of defaulting when the courts are ready as there will be no grace period for appearing on the courts once they are deemed playable.
4. Cancellation of Part of the Match: If a match has officially begun (lineups exchanged and a first serve has been played) and inclement weather, etc. intervenes, the Captains or their representatives may elect to postpone the remaining games.
 - a. The Captain or representatives will reschedule their games within one (1) week of the cancellation.
 - i. All lines must be played before the scheduled season deadline.
 - b. Since lineups have been exchanged, the scheduled players should play the rescheduled games in the lineup they were originally scheduled.
 - i. Once an individual game has officially begun, there can be no substitution of players.
 1. If a player cannot play, that partnership forfeits and the opposing team will be awarded the victory.
 - ii. A rostered player may be used for a player who is unable to play if the individual canceled game had never officially begun but they can not have played in any other games that round.
 - c. Each game starts where it left off; server and service rotation, which side of the court the teams are on and current game score.
5. If canceled, PVTC will send out a revised schedule, extending the season out by 1 week. You will play the same team you were scheduled to play for the rainout.

Etiquette

1. The league is here to **provide fun, friendly competition** for those that love the game.
2. Recreation is the focus of this league.
3. Discipline is at the sole discretion of PVTC.
4. If a team/player continues to violate the rules and regulations, PVTC have the right to suspend and/or remove the team/player from the league.
5. Swearing, negative taunting or poor sportsmanship at any time is **not tolerated**. If disrespect is found between teams, the offenders will **forfeit games and/or will be subject to removal from the league**.
6. If you finish league games early, you are welcome to stay and play until the end of your league slot. Courts will be reserved for each league game.
7. Players are expected to leave the court promptly upon the conclusion of the blocked time for the league.
8. Any player or spectator **NOT on the roster for the day**, must sit in the Patio Area.
 - a. When possible players not actively participating in the current round should sit in the patio area.
 - i. When the patio is full and there is no more room, players may sit quietly on the court while their team is playing

- ii. Rostered players may NOT use cell phones while on the court as it is distracting to other players.
- 9. Water only on the courts.

Playoffs Rules

1. A player must play in at least $\frac{1}{3}$ of the regular league matches in order to participate in playoffs.
 - a. Teams may appeal to the league coordinators if a player does not meet the minimum requirement due to injuries.
2. Teams may advance to the playoffs based on points accumulated during the regular season.
3. If there is a tie going into playoffs, the tiebreaker will be determined by head-to-head, then games won overall, and then total points scored. If the total points scored are also tied, we will determine the winner based on the results of a randomly selected game.
4. If there is a tie in games during the playoffs, the tiebreaker is total points scored in the match, then it is by head-to-head record during the regular season. If the head to head record is tied the team with the best overall record for the season will be declared the winner.